CRANSTON / SALES FAQ / 001

Is Cranston web-based?

Product | Implementation

Short Answer

The main Cranston application is web-based, with a local/desktop connector used where needed to interface with desktop tax software.

More Detail

This distinction matters: the user works in the web app while the connector bridges to supported desktop software.

Proof / Resources

Asked by Erica Whatley.

Direct Quotes

Erica: “And it’s all web based.”

Max: “All web based.”

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

How is a new client populated with demographics and prior-year information?

Workflow | Product

Short Answer

Cranston can pull available information from prior-year returns, organizers, and other uploaded source documents. Missing demographics still need to be supplied somewhere in the source package.

More Detail

The system does not require a special manual demographic form if the necessary values already exist in the documents it can read.

Proof / Resources

Asked by the Pennsylvania prospect during a live demo.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: "Do we have to upload… this demographic information first? … how does it know who this client is?"

Use in: Hands-on Demo, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Does the bookkeeping workflow check the balance sheet and reconciliations?

Product | Workflow

Short Answer

Bookkeeping demos have included reconciliation workflows and balance-sheet review context. Verify the current close/reconciliation feature set before promising a full monthly-close replacement.

More Detail

Separate transaction classification from reconciliation and full close/review; prospects may mean different things by “does the books.”

Proof / Resources

Asked by Erica Whatley.

Direct Quotes

Erica: “And does it check the balance sheet as well?”

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can I see a complete draft return before sending it into tax software?

Workflow | Accuracy | Product

Short Answer

Yes. Cranston provides pre-export views of the proposed return data, and demos have included draft-return output for review before/around the tax-software export workflow.

More Detail

The exact pre-export artifact may differ by integration, but the core requirement is that the reviewer can inspect what Cranston intends to prepare before relying on the final tax-software output.

Proof / Resources

Asked directly by the second prospect in the Christopher Lee recording.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: "Can we see a draft… before sending it out to Drake?"

Use in: Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can changes sync back and forth between Cranston and the tax software?

Integrations | Workflow

Short Answer

Two-way synchronization has been described in pilot conversations, especially for pulling current tax-software state and then adding late documents. Verify current support for the specific tax-software connector before promising full bidirectional sync.

More Detail

The buyer use case is continuing to use the tax software directly while still being able to bring later changes/documents back through Cranston.

Proof / Resources

Asked by Scott Sugg.

Direct Quotes

Cranston team: “That’s two-way sync. So it can sync to Drake and from Drake.”

Use in: Output Review, Desktop Software, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can Cranston replace my tax software?

Product | Integrations | Objections

Short Answer

No. Cranston is currently the AI preparation/automation layer and works with supported tax software; it does not replace the underlying tax engine and e-file system.

More Detail

Be explicit about this distinction when buyers ask whether they can stop paying for Drake, UltraTax, Lacerte, or another tax package.

Proof / Resources

Asked directly by Ed Guerrero.

Direct Quotes

Ed: “This pretty much will replace UltraTax… right?”

Cam: “You will still need UltraTax. We’re just the AI prep.”

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Does Cranston take a backup before writing into desktop tax software?

Integrations | Security | Implementation

Short Answer

A backup-before-write safeguard was discussed in the Lacerte implementation call. Verify that this safeguard applies to the specific connector/environment being deployed.

More Detail

This matters when the prospect already has current-year or rolled-forward data in the live tax file.

Proof / Resources

Discussed during Marty/Brendan's Lacerte review.

Direct Quotes

Cranston team: "We'll also take a backup… before we start writing anything to your system."

Use in: Desktop Software, Onboarding, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Does Cranston write into an existing tax return or create a new return?

Integrations | Workflow | Implementation

Short Answer

The connector workflow can be configured around an existing client/return or a new client where supported. Confirm the desired behavior during implementation so the wrong file is never overwritten.

More Detail

This question becomes especially important when an extension or pro forma return already exists in the tax software.

Proof / Resources

Asked explicitly by Scott Sugg.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: "Is this going to just add data to my existing return or is it creating a new return?"

Use in: Hands-on Demo, Desktop Software, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can Cranston create a workpaper or source-linked review package?

Product | Workflow | Accuracy

Short Answer

Cranston’s workpaper/review views are designed to connect findings and proposed values back to source information. If a prospect requires a specific PDF binder, bookmarking, or export format, verify the current output format before promising it.

More Detail

The underlying buyer need is traceability: reviewers want to understand where a number came from without hunting through the raw client package.

Proof / Resources

Raised in product demos and a prospect question about workpaper/binder-style review output.

Direct Quotes

No stable Max quote captured yet for the exact binder/export format.

Use in: Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Does Cranston perform both preparation and a review layer?

Product | Accuracy | Workflow

Short Answer

Yes. Cranston prepares the draft while also surfacing findings, low-confidence entries, missing documents, prior-year differences, and tax-software diagnostics for human review.

More Detail

It does not eliminate the CPA/reviewer role; it gives that reviewer a more structured layer of evidence and exceptions to inspect.

Proof / Resources

Asked directly by Ed Guerrero and reflected across output-review calls.

Direct Quotes

Ed: "It's doing the prep and a some simultaneous review… right?"

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Does Cranston integrate with Gmail or Outlook for client requests?

Integrations | Workflow

Short Answer

Email integrations with Gmail and Microsoft/Outlook have been demonstrated/described for client-request workflows. Verify current production connector status before setup.

More Detail

The use case is drafting/sending missing-document requests from the firm’s normal email identity and processing responses/documents back into the return workflow.

Proof / Resources

Discussed in sales demos and Ross practice calls.

Direct Quotes

No single evergreen Max quote; current integration status should be checked.

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can I change filing status, dependents, or other client facts from the prior year?

Workflow | Product | Tax Technical

Short Answer

Yes. Current-year facts can be supplied in source documents, preparer notes, or direct instructions and should override prior-year assumptions where appropriate.

More Detail

Prior-year data is context, not an immutable truth. Reviewers can explicitly tell Cranston when filing status, dependents, ownership, addresses, or other facts changed.

Proof / Resources

Asked by the second prospect in the Christopher Lee recording.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: "If… marital status changes from year to year, where do you amend those?"

Use in: Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can Cranston track client document progress as files arrive over time?

Workflow | Product

Short Answer

Client/return status tracking has been discussed in sales demos, and documents can arrive incrementally. Verify the current status-board and client-progress functionality before showing it as a firm-wide workflow replacement.

More Detail

The prospect use case is seeing what has arrived, what is still missing, and where the return sits without manually chasing each file.

Proof / Resources

Asked by Ed Guerrero around a “status bar” for document retrieval.

Direct Quotes

Ed: “The client doesn’t upload everything all at once… do you know if they’re gonna have like a status bar?”

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can Cranston catch duplicate documents?

Accuracy | Workflow | AI

Short Answer

Yes. Duplicate-document detection has been described as part of the workpaper analysis layer.

More Detail

This is part of reasoning across the whole client package rather than processing each source document independently.

Proof / Resources

Discussed in Steven Nuckols and Ross demo flows.

Direct Quotes

Max: "It'll also catch like duplicate documents."

Use in: Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

What kind of return should we use for the first Cranston test?

Implementation | Accuracy

Short Answer

Use a completed return the firm knows well, with representative medium complexity and a known human-reviewed answer. That gives an objective baseline for comparing Cranston's output.

More Detail

Avoid making the first test an unfinished mystery return: if something looks wrong, nobody knows whether the AI or the underlying client data is the problem.

Proof / Resources

Discussed with Steven Nuckols and repeatedly recommended in trial calls.

Direct Quotes

Max: "I would recommend one that you've already done… for the first test."

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

How does Cranston know which tax law or treatment to apply?

Tax Technical | AI | Accuracy

Short Answer

Cranston combines the client’s source documents, prior-year context, firm instructions, tax-software schema, and tax research/guidance available to the product. Ambiguous professional-judgment items should still be surfaced for review.

More Detail

Do not imply that every tax question is automatically resolved with certainty. Deterministic mappings are easier; subjective positions should remain reviewable and traceable.

Proof / Resources

Raised when prospects asked about M-1 items, tax-planning opportunities, mortgage-interest mapping, and research support.

Direct Quotes

No single approved quote; avoid overstating autonomous tax judgment.

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can I use Cranston bookkeeping year-round even outside tax season?

Product | Workflow | Pricing

Short Answer

Historical sales guidance has been yes: firms on the combined offering can use bookkeeping throughout the year even when they are not actively preparing returns.

More Detail

Packaging may still require a tax relationship, but the bookkeeping workflow itself is not limited to tax season.

Proof / Resources

Asked directly by Erica Whatley.

Direct Quotes

Erica: "If this summer I refuse to touch the tax return… would I still be able to do the books?"

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Which returns are the best fit for Cranston, and can we use it only on some returns?

Product | Workflow | Implementation

Short Answer

Firms do not have to use Cranston on every return. Start where the prep/review savings are meaningful, prove value on representative completed returns, and expand based on measured reviewer time saved.

More Detail

Very simple returns may already be inexpensive to prepare manually; complex or document-heavy returns can create more value, provided the source package is sufficiently complete.

Proof / Resources

Raised by Steven Nuckols and the Pennsylvania prospect while deciding what portion of their book to automate.

Direct Quotes

Steven: "What type of returns will it save time on?"

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

What is Cranston’s SOC 2 status?

Security | Objections

Short Answer

Use the current approved status. Historical calls said the SOC 2 Type II examination/audit was in progress. Do not say Cranston is certified unless that has actually been completed and verified.

More Detail

Security-certification status is time-sensitive and especially important with IT/security buyers.

Proof / Resources

Discussed in Jennifer Reardon and internal sales-guidance context.

Direct Quotes

No evergreen direct quote; use the latest approved security language.

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

What customer support do we get during a pilot and after rollout?

Implementation | Objections

Short Answer

Pilots have included hands-on support, implementation help, and a point of contact for questions/troubleshooting. Confirm the current support model and response expectations for the specific deal.

More Detail

Support is part of why minimum commitments matter: implementation is not just a self-serve software login.

Proof / Resources

Asked directly by Scott Sugg and reflected in multiple onboarding calls.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: "Do you have a customer support team if you run into a problem?"

Use in: Discovery, Onboarding, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Do I need client IDs or numbers to map exports to the right tax-software client?

Integrations | Implementation

Short Answer

Often Cranston can match from available client information, but the implementation team should verify mapping keys in the firm’s environment and request IDs where ambiguity exists.

More Detail

Do not assume names alone will be sufficient across every firm and tax-software dataset.

Proof / Resources

Asked during the Marty/Brendan Lacerte review.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: “Do you need client numbers… so they’ll map to the right client?”

Use in: Desktop Software, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

How long has Cranston been in market and how many firms use it?

Objections | Implementation

Short Answer

This is time-sensitive vendor-diligence information. Verify the current company age, customer count, and live-vs-pilot distinction before answering.

More Detail

Prospects ask this to assess maturity, not just curiosity. Be precise about “live,” “pilot,” and “testing.”

Proof / Resources

Asked by Scott Sugg and Ed Guerrero.

Direct Quotes

Ed: “How many… current clients… have gone live with this?”

Use in: Discovery **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Does Cranston pull tax-software diagnostics or calculation errors back into the app?

Integrations | Accuracy | Workflow

Short Answer

Sales demos have shown tax-software calculation errors/diagnostics surfaced back in Cranston after export. Confirm current behavior for the buyer’s tax software.

More Detail

This gives the reviewer a second feedback layer after the tax engine recalculates the return.

Proof / Resources

Demonstrated in Erica Whatley and Ed Guerrero calls.

Direct Quotes

Max: “If after populating it, it creates a flag in Drake, it’ll show right here.”

Use in: Hands-on Demo, Output Review, Desktop Software **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Does Cranston integrate with Canopy?

Integrations | Workflow

Short Answer

Canopy document movement/integration has been demonstrated in calls. Verify current connector behavior and setup before making a technical commitment.

More Detail

The buyer use case is keeping Canopy as the client/document-management layer while Cranston handles preparation.

Proof / Resources

Discussed in Ed Guerrero’s call.

Direct Quotes

Cam: “We do have an integration with Canopy.”

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Where is client data stored and how is it protected?

Security

Short Answer

Use Cranston’s current approved security documentation. Sales calls have consistently described US-based infrastructure, sandboxing, encryption, and enterprise/API access to model providers.

More Detail

Do not improvise technical details such as exact hosting regions, retention periods, or subprocessors. If a prospect needs specifics, send the approved security material or get engineering to verify.

Proof / Resources

Raised by Steven Nuckols, Erica Whatley, Scott Sugg, Ray, and others.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: “Where is client information going… and what’s the security protocols?”

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

How and when does Cranston bill us?

Pricing | Implementation

Short Answer

Billing structure has varied with the deal. Use the current order form/pricing policy for timing, deposits, true-ups, and pilot billing rather than relying on a transcript.

More Detail

Some historical calls described a portion billed at the start of tax season and the balance later; pilots and custom deals may differ.

Proof / Resources

Asked by Ed Guerrero and Erica Whatley.

Direct Quotes

No evergreen billing quote; contract/order form is the source of truth.

Use in: Discovery, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Do I need client consent or an IRC §7216 disclosure to use Cranston?

Security | Tax Technical

Short Answer

Do not improvise a legal answer. Use Cranston’s approved legal/compliance guidance for the firm’s exact workflow and escalate if the prospect wants a legal interpretation of IRC §7216.

More Detail

This question depends on how data is disclosed, processed, and where services are performed. The sales team should not substitute an off-the-cuff analogy for approved compliance guidance.

Proof / Resources

Raised by Christopher Lee and in Ross role-play/security practice.

Direct Quotes

Prospect context: “I currently don’t do 7216 disclosures for 1040 returns…”

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Does Cranston integrate with TaxDome?

Integrations | Workflow

Short Answer

Check the current TaxDome integration status before promising a direct connector. Cranston can still fit alongside a TaxDome-centered workflow even when the automation depth differs.

More Detail

Prospects often want TaxDome to remain the source of truth for client management/document intake.

Proof / Resources

Asked directly by Erica Whatley and raised in multiple other calls.

Direct Quotes

Erica: "Do you guys connect directly to TaxDome?"

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Does Cranston replace QuickBooks?

Product | Integrations

Short Answer

No. Cranston’s bookkeeping automation works with the accounting system rather than replacing the underlying ledger.

More Detail

Position Cranston as the automation layer for transaction classification/matching/reconciliation, not as a new general ledger.

Proof / Resources

This concern appeared in bookkeeping comparisons across sales calls.

Direct Quotes

No standard Max quote captured yet; add future wording here.

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can Cranston recreate a prior-year return to establish rollforward?

Workflow | Integrations | Implementation

Short Answer

This workflow has been discussed as a desired/rolling capability. Verify current product availability before promising automated prior-year recreation.

More Detail

The use case is onboarding a new client by rebuilding their most recent filed return in the firm’s software so the next year rolls forward cleanly.

Proof / Resources

Asked directly by Christopher Lee.

Direct Quotes

Christopher: “Would there be a good way to use this tool to help us expedite that recreation process?”

Use in: Hands-on Demo, Desktop Software, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

How much manual review is still required?

Accuracy | Workflow | Staffing / Replacement

Short Answer

Cranston is designed to eliminate a large portion of manual preparation and document hunting, while keeping professional review and judgment in the workflow.

More Detail

Review effort varies by return complexity, source-document quality, and how much firm-specific logic has been configured.

Proof / Resources

Raised across nearly every evaluation call, especially firms comparing AI with preparers/offshore teams.

Direct Quotes

No single standard Max quote captured; continue collecting wording here.

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

How do I know Cranston will still be around long term?

Objections | Implementation

Short Answer

Answer with current, verifiable company facts: funding, customer traction, team, and financial plan. Do not reuse historical runway numbers without checking them first.

More Detail

This is a legitimate switching-risk objection because firms do not want to rebuild their workflow around a vendor that disappears.

Proof / Resources

Asked explicitly by Christopher Lee as funding runway / path to cash-flow-positive.

Direct Quotes

Christopher: "What's your funding runway look like? … what does it look like to a road where you guys are cash flow positive?"

Use in: Discovery **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can Cranston match a lower-priced competitor?

Pricing | Competition | Objections

Short Answer

Do not promise a price match without approval. Special pricing has been negotiated on individual deals, but it should not be treated as standard policy.

More Detail

Prospects have compared Cranston with $20-$27/return offers. The right response is to understand the scope/terms and escalate any concession request.

Proof / Resources

Raised by Ed Guerrero and the second prospect in the Christopher Lee recording.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: "Could you guys be competitive for that?"

Internal note: prior price-match offers were deal-specific, not a reusable policy.

Use in: Discovery **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Do you offer volume discounts for larger commitments?

Pricing

Short Answer

Volume discounts have been discussed for larger commitments, but discount levels require current sales approval rather than a standing promise.

More Detail

Prospects with hundreds or thousands of returns frequently ask whether unit pricing falls with commitment size.

Proof / Resources

Asked by Steven Nuckols, Laura McClure, Ed Guerrero, and others.

Direct Quotes

Max: “If you’re willing to commit up front for 500 or a thousand returns, we can talk about a discount.”

Use in: Discovery **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

How does the desktop connector work?

Integrations | Implementation

Short Answer

Cranston installs a desktop-side application/connector that interfaces with the supported tax software. It is not positioned as browser-style computer-use automation.

More Detail

Prospects often ask whether the integration uses an API, UI automation, or an installed local app. Use current technical documentation if they need implementation specifics.

Proof / Resources

Asked by Christopher Lee and the Pennsylvania prospect.

Direct Quotes

Max: "We install an app on your desktop that allows us to interface with Drake directly."

Use in: Hands-on Demo, Desktop Software, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Does Cranston connect to QuickBooks Online and Xero?

Integrations | Product

Short Answer

Both QuickBooks Online and Xero were represented as supported bookkeeping systems in sales calls. Verify current connector status before implementation.

More Detail

The buyer question is usually whether they can retain their existing bookkeeping ledger while Cranston automates classification/reconciliation.

Proof / Resources

Asked by Christopher Lee; QuickBooks Online was demonstrated to Erica Whatley.

Direct Quotes

Christopher: "Is it both Xero and QuickBooks?"

Max: "It is Xero and QuickBooks."

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

What happens when Cranston is unsure where to map or treat an item?

Accuracy | Workflow | Tax Technical

Short Answer

It should surface the ambiguity as a finding or low-confidence item so the preparer/reviewer can direct the treatment rather than silently inventing certainty.

More Detail

The system can use prior-year treatment and firm instructions as context, but professional judgment remains available when multiple treatments are plausible.

Proof / Resources

Raised in the Pennsylvania prospect call and Marty/Brendan return-review discussions.

Direct Quotes

Prospect asked how Cranston knows whether mortgage interest belongs on Form 8829 or Schedule A.

Use in: Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can Cranston surface tax-planning opportunities from source documents?

Product	Tax Technical	AI

Short Answer

Yes. Findings can include potential planning opportunities such as retirement/HSA contributions or deduction opportunities, in addition to missing-document and data-quality issues.

More Detail

Treat these as suggestions for professional review, not automatic tax advice that bypasses the CPA’s judgment.

Proof / Resources

Demonstrated in multiple calls including Steven Nuckols, Erica Whatley, and Ross practice/demo sessions.

Direct Quotes

No single standard Max quote; demos repeatedly show “opportunities” alongside findings.

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Does Cranston preserve prior-year rollforward data and fixed assets?

Integrations | Workflow | Tax Technical

Short Answer

The implementation should be configured so prior-year data that the firm wants preserved is not unintentionally overwritten. Validate this in the firm’s actual software before rollout.

More Detail

Firms specifically care about fixed-asset schedules, prior-year values, Schedule B answers, and other rollforward state.

Proof / Resources

Raised in the Marty/Brendan Lacerte review.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: “Is it going to overwrite prior stuff that’s already been rolled forward…?”

Use in: Output Review, Desktop Software, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Is bookkeeping only available as an add-on to tax?

Product | Pricing

Short Answer

Historical call guidance has been that bookkeeping is sold in tandem with tax rather than as a standalone product. Verify current packaging before quoting it.

More Detail

This is packaging, not a technical limitation: a firm may use bookkeeping year-round even if it is not actively preparing returns in the summer.

Proof / Resources

Asked by Erica Whatley and discussed with Christopher Lee.

Direct Quotes

Erica: "You set the bookkeeping as an add-on. So you have to do a tax return in order to have the books."

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can Cranston batch migrate or export multiple clients, or is it return-by-return?

Workflow | Integrations | Implementation

Short Answer

Batch workflows have been discussed, but the exact operational model depends on tax software and current connector capabilities. Verify the current bulk/export flow during implementation.

More Detail

This matters to firms moving many extension clients or performing an initial pilot migration.

Proof / Resources

Asked by Brendan Daly during the Lacerte review.

Direct Quotes

Brendan: "Is it going to be… return by return… or…?"

Use in: Desktop Software, Onboarding, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

What is the current status of the UltraTax integration?

Integrations | Implementation

Short Answer

Verify the current UltraTax status before answering. Historical calls gave rollout estimates that should not be repeated as current commitments.

More Detail

UltraTax has been a gating requirement for multiple prospects. Separate "internal testing," "available for pilot," and "generally available" clearly.

Proof / Resources

Raised by Ed Guerrero, Robert Johnson, Joey Greco, and Ray/Scott-related calls.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: "Have you guys done it with UltraTax or will be doing it with UltraTax?"

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Desktop Software **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Does Cranston support client signatures and delivery?

Product | Workflow

Short Answer

Client-delivery/signature functionality has been demonstrated, while firms can also keep tools like DocuSign. Verify current production status and supported signature workflow before promising it.

More Detail

The product does not need to replace the firm’s existing signature process if the firm prefers to keep it.

Proof / Resources

Asked by Ed Guerrero.

Direct Quotes

Ed: “This could replace DocuSign too…?”

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

What security and privacy commitments are documented in the contract?

Security | Implementation

Short Answer

The order form/contract and security materials should be the source of truth for written commitments. Send those documents rather than paraphrasing them when the buyer asks for contractual assurances.

More Detail

Prospects want written confirmation of data-security representations before purchasing.

Proof / Resources

Asked directly by Scott Sugg.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: "Is there some sort of an agreement… your data is secured under this…?"

Use in: Discovery, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

How is bookkeeping priced?

Pricing | Product

Short Answer

Historical calls quoted bookkeeping at $30 per company per month. Verify current pricing before using that number in a live conversation.

More Detail

Bookkeeping pricing has been described separately from per-return tax pricing and may be tied to the tax package.

Proof / Resources

Asked by Erica Whatley.

Direct Quotes

Max: "For the bookkeeping, it's $30 per company per month."

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can Cranston learn our firm-specific tax and review rules?

AI	Workflow	Tax Technical

Short Answer

Yes. Firm-level instructions can be used for recurring policies and preferences so the system applies them consistently across returns.

More Detail

Examples include capitalization thresholds and other standardized firm practices. This is different from training a base AI model on client data.

Proof / Resources

Asked directly by Steven Nuckols.

Direct Quotes

Max: "We have an instructions folder where you can set firm level practices… that will apply to all returns."

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Which tax software integrations are supported today?

Integrations | Product

Short Answer

Integration status changes quickly. Check the current supported-integration list before every call rather than relying on an old sales transcript.

More Detail

Prospects have asked specifically about Drake, Lacerte, UltraTax, CCH Axcess, ProConnect, TaxDome, Canopy, and hosted desktop environments. Be precise about what is live, in testing, or planned.

Proof / Resources

This question appears across many Circleback demos and follow-ups.

Direct Quotes

No single static quote should be reused because integration status is time-sensitive.

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Desktop Software **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can Cranston catch missing prior-year K-1s or recurring forms?

Accuracy | Workflow | Tax Technical

Short Answer

Yes. Prior-year comparison can flag recurring forms/documents that appear to be missing this year.

More Detail

One sales example described a client with four K-1s in the prior year but only three supplied in the current year.

Proof / Resources

Discussed in Ed Guerrero’s demo and other findings demonstrations.

Direct Quotes

Cam/team: “It noticed it had four K-1s last year, but it was only given info for three this year.”

Use in: Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

What is the minimum return commitment?

Pricing | Implementation

Short Answer

Minimum-commitment guidance has varied by deal and call. Do not assume one universal number; use the current standard pricing policy and get approval for exceptions.

More Detail

Historical calls referenced minimums ranging from roughly 100-150 to 250 returns depending on the context. That variation is exactly why this should be treated as a current sales-policy question.

Proof / Resources

Raised by Erica Whatley, Laura McClure, Steven Nuckols, Ed Guerrero, and others.

Direct Quotes

Max has used different minimums in different calls; verify the current standard before quoting one.

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can Cranston use brokerage and cost-basis data to identify planning opportunities?

Product	Tax Technical	AI

Short Answer

Yes. Additional financial context can be used to surface tax-planning opportunities when the user directs Cranston to analyze it, while irrelevant detail does not need to be written into the tax return.

More Detail

The buyer can ask the agent to look across cost-basis or brokerage information and identify tax-mitigation opportunities rather than treating every line as a return input.

Proof / Resources

Asked by Steven Nuckols.

Direct Quotes

Steven asked whether brokerage/cost-basis information could "give good advice."

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

How accurate are Cranston-prepared returns?

Accuracy | Objections

Short Answer

Prove accuracy on the prospect’s own completed returns rather than relying on a blanket percentage. Cranston exposes findings and proposed tax-software fields so reviewers can validate the result before relying on it.

More Detail

A historical call included a very strong numerical accuracy claim. Do not reuse that as approved sales language unless Cranston has current substantiation for the metric and its test methodology.

Proof / Resources

Asked explicitly by the second prospect in the Christopher Lee recording and indirectly by many pilot prospects.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: “How accurate is the AI generated return… versus a human?”

Internal note: historical percentage wording should be verified before reuse.

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

How is Cranston different from TaxGPT, Juno, or Geno?

Competition | Objections

Short Answer

Anchor the comparison in the buyer’s actual workflow: supported return complexity, desktop integration method, ability to review/modify before export, business-return depth, and how well the product works on their own completed returns. Avoid making unverified claims about competitors.

More Detail

Prospects routinely arrive after seeing TaxGPT, Juno, Geno, Magnetic, or other AI-prep tools. Ask what they liked/disliked and demonstrate the Cranston difference against that criterion.

Proof / Resources

Competition was discussed in Erica Whatley, Christopher Lee, Ed Guerrero, Steven Nuckols, and conference-prospect conversations.

Direct Quotes

Erica: “I did try Juno… I’m not a fan of Juno.”

Christopher discussed Geno and wanted deeper business-return/import capabilities.

Use in: Discovery **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can we lock in pricing for multiple years?

Pricing | Objections

Short Answer

Multi-year pricing has been discussed in individual negotiations. Any locked rate, term, or volume guarantee needs current approval and should be documented in the contract.

More Detail

Long-term vendor stability and predictable unit cost are important to firms that expect to keep a system for five to ten years.

Proof / Resources

Asked by the second prospect in the Christopher Lee recording.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: "What would be the much better deal for the long run?"

Use in: Discovery **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Where should admins, preparers, and reviewers use Cranston in the workflow?

Workflow | Implementation | Staffing / Replacement

Short Answer

A common rollout is: admins handle document intake, preparers resolve tax/prep findings, and reviewers validate the finished return and important judgment calls. The exact split should match the firm’s staffing model.

More Detail

The product can shift work down the cost stack, but non-accounting admins should not be expected to resolve accounting/tax judgments they are not qualified to make.

Proof / Resources

Asked in detail by Steven Nuckols.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: “Are they having basically like a non-preparer… and then it gets escalated to preparer or reviewer?”

Use in: Discovery, Onboarding, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Does Cranston handle client payments or invoicing?

Product | Workflow

Short Answer

Historical call guidance was that payment collection itself was not a core Cranston function; invoicing/association may be possible in the delivery workflow. Verify current capabilities before answering.

More Detail

Separate “create/associate an invoice” from “process the client’s payment.”

Proof / Resources

Asked by Ed Guerrero.

Direct Quotes

Ed: “Do y’all have anything for payments, or do we just do it manually?”

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

How does Cranston get smarter without training base AI models on client data?

AI | Security

Short Answer

The sales explanation has been that Cranston improves by accumulating more firm/client context, instructions, and workflow history inside the secured product-not by relying on the underlying model provider to train its base model on customer data.

More Detail

Keep the distinction clear between Cranston retaining authorized context for its application and a third-party base model being trained on that data.

Proof / Resources

Asked directly by Steven Nuckols.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: "How does the AI then keep improving and learning?"

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

What does Cranston overwrite when it writes to desktop tax software?

Integrations | Workflow | Implementation

Short Answer

The write behavior can be configured around the firm’s desired workflow. Before any live rollout, explicitly agree on what current-year data should change and what prior/rolled-forward information must be preserved.

More Detail

This is a critical implementation question for firms with fixed assets, Schedule B answers, prior-year rollforward data, and existing current-year returns.

Proof / Resources

Asked directly during Marty/Brendan’s Lacerte review.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: “What does it override things? … what’s kind of the interface to make sure we can handle whatever conflicts come up there?”

Use in: Output Review, Desktop Software, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

How clean do business-return source documents need to be?

Workflow | Accuracy | Product

Short Answer

Cleaner source data produces a faster, cleaner draft. Cranston can work through messy packages, but unresolved bookkeeping or ambiguous adjustments will create more findings and require more human decisions.

More Detail

For business returns, a clean P&L/balance sheet/trial balance is fundamentally different from asking AI to reconstruct incomplete books from raw bank statements.

Proof / Resources

Discussed in Steven Nuckols and business-return review calls.

Direct Quotes

Max: "The cleaner the better."

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Why should we pay more than a $20-$27-per-return competitor?

Pricing | Competition | Objections

Short Answer

Do not defend price in the abstract. Compare total workflow value: supported return complexity, number of reruns/drafts included, review effort, integration reliability, implementation/support, and reviewer time saved. Then escalate pricing if the economics still do not work.

More Detail

The right comparison is cost per successfully prepared/reviewed return and reviewer minutes saved, not just sticker price per run.

Proof / Resources

Raised directly by Ed Guerrero and the second prospect in the Christopher Lee recording.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: "I already got spoiled… at 20 bucks a return."

Use in: Discovery **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Is Cranston only for accounting firms, or will it sell direct to consumers?

Objections | Competition

Short Answer

The historical sales answer has been that Cranston is focused on accounting firms/business customers rather than direct-to-consumer tax filing. Verify current go-to-market strategy if this becomes material to a deal.

More Detail

Prospects ask this because they do not want to adopt a vendor that may later compete directly for their clients.

Proof / Resources

Asked directly by Christopher Lee.

Direct Quotes

Christopher: "Is there a path where you try to sell this direct to consumer…?"

Use in: Discovery **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can Cranston work in hosted or locked-down desktop environments?

Integrations | Implementation | Security

Short Answer

Usually yes, but installation may require coordination with the firm’s hosting provider or IT administrator. Validate the exact environment before promising a frictionless install.

More Detail

Prospects have named Verito, RightWorks, Ace Cloud, Venn/OS33, and other hosted/locked-down environments.

Proof / Resources

Raised by Erica Whatley, Christopher Lee, and the Pennsylvania prospect.

Direct Quotes

Erica: “My Drake is in a hosted environment. Is that okay?”

Use in: Discovery, Desktop Software, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

What bookkeeping functions does Cranston automate?

Product | Workflow

Short Answer

Sales calls have described transaction classification, matching, and reconciliation automation, with review of uncertain items before posting.

More Detail

Keep bookkeeping scope separate from tax-prep scope. If a prospect asks about a specific close/accounting workflow, verify current functionality.

Proof / Resources

Discussed in Erica Whatley and Christopher Lee calls.

Direct Quotes

Max: "It's basically just transaction classification and then… reconciliation automation."

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can Cranston read very large PDFs and information buried deep in them?

Product | Accuracy

Short Answer

Yes, but very large documents can make specific buried items harder to find. If an expected item is missed, point Cranston to the file or section and have it re-check.

More Detail

A Texas Public Information Report was buried at the end of a 100+ page package; the team discussed prompting the agent to search the source file again rather than re-uploading the page.

Proof / Resources

Observed in Marty McCutchen / Brendan Daly return review.

Direct Quotes

Brendan: "It's buried all the way at the bottom of that PDF."

Use in: Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can Cranston handle special allocations on partnership returns?

Product | Tax Technical

Short Answer

Yes, when Cranston is given sufficiently explicit instructions or a structured workpaper showing the intended allocation.

More Detail

The sales-call framing has been that if a human can enter the field in the supported tax software, Cranston can generally execute it when the source data and instructions are clear.

Proof / Resources

Asked directly by Christopher Lee.

Direct Quotes

Max: "You can import it. You just have to tell the software how you want it done."

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Does Cranston support all 50 states and local or municipal forms?

Product | Tax Technical

Short Answer

The sales-call answer has been that all 50 states are supported, with local and municipal coverage more variable. Verify specific local forms when they matter to the buyer.

More Detail

State support is often asked immediately after pricing or federal form support. Local and city forms should not be over-promised without checking the exact jurisdiction.

Proof / Resources

Raised in the Pennsylvania prospect call and Ed Guerrero demo.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: "Do you do all states? Are you missing any forms?"

Max: "We do all 50 states."

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can I review every field Cranston plans to enter before export?

Workflow | Accuracy | Product

Short Answer

Yes. The Draft view is designed to show the target tax-software fields and the values Cranston plans to enter, with confidence/flagging before export.

More Detail

This is one of the core trust mechanisms: reviewers can inspect proposed entries before the system writes into tax software.

Proof / Resources

Repeatedly demonstrated in Steven Nuckols, Erica Whatley, Christopher Lee, Ed Guerrero, and other calls.

Direct Quotes

Max: "It shows you on the right what it's going to put into all those fields."

Use in: Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can Cranston generate an organizer or document-retrieval checklist?

Workflow | Product

Short Answer

This capability was discussed as available/being rolled out in sales calls. Because rollout status can change, verify the current organizer/client-request functionality before promising it.

More Detail

The buyer use case is to generate a checklist from prior-year information and let clients supply documents incrementally.

Proof / Resources

Asked by Ed Guerrero and discussed in other onboarding calls.

Direct Quotes

Ed: "Would your system be able to make… a document retrieval checklist for the client?"

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can Cranston import new partners or S-corp shareholders?

Product | Tax Technical | Workflow

Short Answer

The call guidance has been yes: fields that can be entered manually in the supported tax software can generally be populated by Cranston when the underlying data is provided.

More Detail

For new owners, confirm that all identifying, ownership, and allocation information needed by the tax software is available.

Proof / Resources

Asked in Christopher Lee’s call.

Direct Quotes

Max: “Any field that you can put into Drake manually, we can push.”

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

What happens when a client sends a corrected or replacement document?

Workflow | Product

Short Answer

Upload the replacement document or tell Cranston what changed, then have it recalculate/update the draft.

More Detail

The workflow is intentionally conversational: treat Cranston like an employee receiving an updated source document and instructions.

Proof / Resources

Asked explicitly by Scott Sugg during review.

Direct Quotes

Max/team: "You can either upload a document… or you can type… 'here's a new document replacement.'"

Use in: Hands-on Demo, Output Review, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Does Cranston support trusts or Form 990?

Product	Tax Technical

Short Answer

Not in the call guidance captured to date. Prospects were told trusts and Form 990 were not currently supported. Re-check current product support before each call.

More Detail

This is a common boundary question after the four supported federal return types are listed.

Proof / Resources

Raised in the Christopher Lee recording and the merged second prospect call; trusts were also raised in another demo.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: "Any 990s?"

Max: "No, no 990s."

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Which federal return types does Cranston support today?

Product | Tax Technical

Short Answer

Current sales-call guidance has been: 1040, 1065, 1120, and 1120S. Verify the current supported-form list before promising support for anything else.

More Detail

Prospects repeatedly ask whether business returns are supported in addition to 1040s. The consistent call answer has been those four core federal return types.

Proof / Resources

Asked in Circleback calls including Erica Whatley, Ed Guerrero, Christopher Lee, and other demos.

Direct Quotes

Max: "We do 1040, 1065, 1120, and 1120S."

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Does the tax software need to be open while Cranston imports?

Integrations | Workflow

Short Answer

For the desktop workflows discussed in calls, the answer has been no: the tax software does not need to remain open for Cranston’s connector to work.

More Detail

This often comes up when prospects compare Cranston with UI-automation tools that occupy the desktop application while importing.

Proof / Resources

Asked directly by Erica Whatley.

Direct Quotes

Erica: “Does Drake have to be open?”

Max: “Yeah, it can be open or closed.”

Use in: Hands-on Demo, Desktop Software, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can I keep using TaxDome, Canopy, Financial Sense, or another client portal?

Integrations | Workflow

Short Answer

Yes in principle: Cranston is meant to fit into an existing firm workflow rather than force a new client portal. The exact integration depth varies by system, so verify the current connector/status before promising automation.

More Detail

Prospects have specifically asked about TaxDome, Canopy, and Financial Sense.

Proof / Resources

Raised by Erica Whatley, Ed Guerrero, Christopher Lee, and Steven Nuckols.

Direct Quotes

Erica: "I use TaxDome, I can pull everything out of TaxDome…?"

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can Cranston handle M-1 adjustments and book-to-tax differences?

Product | Tax Technical

Short Answer

Yes for deterministic adjustments and rules it can derive or has been instructed to follow; subjective items should surface for review rather than be blindly assumed.

More Detail

This came up around meals, depreciation, officer compensation, and other business-return book-to-tax differences.

Proof / Resources

Asked by Brendan Daly during a return-review call.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: "What is the capability for… M-1 adjustments or book-to-tax differences?"

Use in: Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can I upload one combined PDF containing many client documents?

Product | Workflow

Short Answer

Yes. Cranston is designed to reason across mixed document packages, including consolidated PDFs, although unusually large or poorly scanned files may create more review flags.

More Detail

Prospects explicitly contrasted this with systems that require each source document to be classified or uploaded separately.

Proof / Resources

Raised in the Pennsylvania prospect call and other workflow discussions.

Direct Quotes

Prospect described clients who "send me one PDF file and everything is in there."

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can Cranston handle owner-financed transactions?

Product | Tax Technical

Short Answer

The product was represented as able to handle owner-finance scenarios when the necessary source documents and tax treatment are provided. For unusual structures, verify the exact workflow.

More Detail

Treat this as a tax-treatment and source-document question rather than a simple yes/no feature checkbox when the transaction is complex.

Proof / Resources

Asked directly in Ed Guerrero’s discovery/demo call.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: “And how about owner finance stuff? Same thing?”

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can I tell Cranston to ignore or change a value or tax treatment?

Workflow | Product | Tax Technical

Short Answer

Yes. You can dismiss a finding, provide an instruction, upload supporting information, or explicitly tell Cranston how the item should be treated.

More Detail

The product is meant to preserve accountant judgment rather than force the AI’s initial interpretation.

Proof / Resources

Demonstrated across multiple sales and review calls.

Direct Quotes

Max: “You can type an answer… \[or\] dismiss it if it’s not relevant.”

Use in: Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

How long does Cranston take to analyze and export a return?

Workflow | Implementation

Short Answer

Calls have typically described roughly 20 minutes for AI analysis plus about 5-10 minutes for export, with more time for larger/complex packages. Treat those as observed/typical, not a guaranteed SLA.

More Detail

Human review time is separate from model processing time.

Proof / Resources

Asked by Erica Whatley and discussed in several trial/onboarding calls.

Direct Quotes

Max: "To produce those findings, it will take about 20 minutes on average."

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can clients securely upload requested documents from a Cranston email?

Workflow | Security | Product

Short Answer

Sales demos have shown a secure portal-upload option that can be included with client requests.

More Detail

This lets a firm ask for a missing document and give the client a secure upload path tied to the request.

Proof / Resources

Demonstrated in Christopher Lee and other calls.

Direct Quotes

Max: "You can also add secure portal upload."

Use in: Hands-on Demo, Output Review, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can Cranston handle multi-state apportionment?

Product	Tax Technical

Short Answer

Cranston can use structured workpapers and instructions to drive multi-state entries, but highly customized apportionment should be demonstrated on the prospect’s own return before making a broad promise.

More Detail

A prospect specifically wanted an apportionment workpaper that reconciles source figures and pushes adjusted state values into tax software.

Proof / Resources

Raised in Christopher Lee’s call.

Direct Quotes

Christopher: “Is there a plan to expand this out to like multi-state apportionment…?”

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can Cranston e-file, or do I still need tax software?

Product | Integrations | Workflow

Short Answer

Cranston has been sold as the preparation/automation layer, not a replacement e-file engine. You still need the supported tax software unless the product offering changes.

More Detail

Prospects frequently ask whether Cranston replaces Drake, UltraTax, Lacerte, etc. The current sales answer should clearly distinguish the AI prep layer from the tax software/e-file system.

Proof / Resources

Asked in Ed Guerrero and Pennsylvania prospect calls.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: "You don't e-file the returns if I didn't have the tax software, right?"

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can I add a missing document after a return has already been pushed to tax software?

Workflow | Integrations

Short Answer

The workflow was demonstrated as supporting incremental documents and synchronization after an initial draft/export. Verify the current two-way-sync behavior for the buyer’s exact tax software.

More Detail

This matters for late W-2s, 1095-A forms, and other documents clients commonly provide after prep has started.

Proof / Resources

Asked by Scott Sugg.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: “If I was missing a document that I now receive, I can just add it and it’ll update?”

Use in: Output Review, Desktop Software, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

How many returns can Cranston process or export at once?

Workflow | Product

Short Answer

Parallel/batch processing has been demonstrated, but do not promise a fixed maximum from memory. Verify current concurrency limits for the prospect's workflow.

More Detail

One call explicitly discussed pushing many returns at once. Product limits can change as infrastructure changes.

Proof / Resources

Asked by the second prospect in the Christopher Lee recording.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: "How many returns can I push at one time?"

Use in: Hands-on Demo, Output Review, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Are there document, page, or file-size limits?

Product | Workflow

Short Answer

Do not quote a hard limit from memory. Large packages are supported, but exact file/page limits should be checked against current product documentation.

More Detail

Prospects have asked this while discussing large PDFs and complex business returns. Treat any exact numerical limit as a current product-spec question.

Proof / Resources

Raised across product demos involving large source packages.

Direct Quotes

No stable Max quote should be reused until the current product limit is verified.

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can Cranston handle rental properties and Schedule E?

Product	Tax Technical

Short Answer

Yes. Rental-property and Schedule E workflows have been demonstrated and tested in prospect calls.

More Detail

The system can work from rental documents and schedules, surface missing or ambiguous items, and prepare the corresponding tax-software entries for review.

Proof / Resources

Asked directly by Ed Guerrero; rental-property testing also appeared in Scott Sugg and Erica Whatley calls.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: “You guys handle that as well?”

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can I combine multiple client requests into one email?

Workflow | Product

Short Answer

Yes. Multiple findings can be selected and combined into one client request/email draft.

More Detail

This is useful for avoiding a stream of separate emails for each missing item.

Proof / Resources

Asked explicitly by Scott Sugg.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: "Do I have to ask the client in like three different emails or can I ask… in one email?"

Use in: Hands-on Demo, Output Review, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can Cranston read handwritten client notes?

Product | Accuracy

Short Answer

Yes, Cranston can read scanned handwriting, although accuracy still depends on legibility and ambiguous handwriting should be reviewed.

More Detail

This is a recurring concern for firms with paper-heavy or older clients. The right expectation is "can read it and flag uncertainty," not "every handwritten note is guaranteed perfect."

Proof / Resources

Asked in Scott Sugg, Steven Nuckols, Ed Guerrero, and other calls.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: "Is this thing gonna pick up handwritten stuff as well?"

Max/team: "Yeah… it's good at handwriting."

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Does Cranston send client emails automatically or draft them for review?

Workflow | Product

Short Answer

Cranston can draft client-request emails from selected findings. The exact send/approval behavior should match the firm’s configured workflow and should not be assumed without checking.

More Detail

Prospects specifically ask whether the system sends automatically or produces a draft they can review and send themselves.

Proof / Resources

Asked in the Pennsylvania prospect call and demonstrated in multiple demos.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: “Does it send out emails to clients automatically, or will it… draft me an email that I could send?”

Use in: Hands-on Demo, Output Review, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

What file formats can I upload to Cranston?

Product | Workflow

Short Answer

Sales demos have shown PDFs, spreadsheets, Word-like documents, images, screenshots, scanned documents, and handwritten-note images. Verify any unusual format before promising it.

More Detail

The key point is that Cranston is designed to ingest a mixed client package rather than requiring one strict document type.

Proof / Resources

Discussed in Steven Nuckols, Ed Guerrero, Erica Whatley, and Christopher Lee demos.

Direct Quotes

Max: "We can ingest like PDFs, spreadsheets… a picture of a handwritten note."

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can Cranston handle complex K-1s and supplemental K-1 data?

Product | Tax Technical

Short Answer

K-1s are part of supported workflows, including prior-year comparison and missing-K-1 detection. Very complex supplemental K-1 or K-2/K-3 cases should be validated on an example before promising full automation.

More Detail

Several prospects specifically care about business-return complexity and large K-1 lists. Cranston has been positioned as a way to ingest and reason across those documents, while surfacing ambiguity for review.

Proof / Resources

K-1 complexity was discussed in Christopher Lee, Erica Whatley, Steven Nuckols, and other calls.

Direct Quotes

No reusable Max quote captured yet for the most complex supplemental-K-1 version of this question.

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Does Cranston use prior-year workpapers when preparing the next year?

Workflow | AI

Short Answer

The product has been positioned as accumulating richer firm/client context over time, including prior-year return and workflow context. Verify the exact persistence of prior-year workpaper data in the current product before promising specifics.

More Detail

A prospect specifically asked whether the next year would use both the prior return and the prior workpaper as a guidepost.

Proof / Resources

Raised by Steven Nuckols.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: "Is it using… previous return but previous work paper as kind of a guidepost in the next year?"

Use in: Hands-on Demo, Output Review, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Is there a special prompt I should use when Cranston misses something?

Workflow | AI

Short Answer

No magic phrase is required. Tell Cranston plainly what it missed and what you want it to re-check or change, just as you would instruct a preparer.

More Detail

When a document or value is missed, point the agent back to the source and describe the expected correction.

Proof / Resources

Asked during Marty/Brendan review and Scott Sugg review.

Direct Quotes

Prospect: "Is there like a phrase we need to type in… to make it recognize?"

Use in: Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Does Cranston compare against the prior-year return and organizer?

Workflow | Accuracy

Short Answer

Yes. Prior-year returns and organizers are used as context for missing-document detection, year-over-year review, and preparation.

More Detail

The system can use the prior-year return to spot missing recurring items and to populate/compare client information.

Proof / Resources

Asked directly by Steven Nuckols and the Pennsylvania prospect.

Direct Quotes

Max: "It'll look at the previous year's return."

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

How does Cranston know which documents are missing?

Workflow | Accuracy | AI

Short Answer

It compares the current-year source package against context such as the prior-year return and organizer, then surfaces likely missing documents as findings.

More Detail

Examples from calls include a prior-year mortgage statement with no current-year 1098 and four prior-year K-1s when only three appeared this year.

Proof / Resources

Demonstrated in Steven Nuckols and Ed Guerrero calls.

Direct Quotes

Max: "It'll spot things that are missing from the organizer… \[and\] look at the previous year's return."

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can I keep working on my computer or tax software while an import runs?

Integrations | Workflow | Competition

Short Answer

Yes, the connector has been positioned as not taking over the computer via UI automation. Avoid editing the exact same return while it is being written, but other work can continue.

More Detail

This is a key contrast prospects raise versus tools that use computer-use/UI automation and block the workstation.

Proof / Resources

Raised in Erica Whatley and Christopher Lee calls.

Direct Quotes

Max: "You can use your computer while you do it."

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Desktop Software **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Is client data used to train AI models?

Security | AI

Short Answer

Cranston's sales language is that it uses **enterprise/API-grade access to AI providers so customer data is not used by those providers to train their models**.

More Detail

Keep this answer focused on Cranston's enterprise/API setup and the company's actual data-handling controls. Do not make broader claims about consumer AI products. If a prospect asks about legal/compliance specifics, SOC 2, retention, or client-consent requirements, answer only from the current approved security documentation or bring in the appropriate technical/legal owner.

Proof / Resources

Sources: Steven Nuckols call and Ray Busch call this week. **Internal note:** security/compliance language should be kept synchronized with the current approved security policy.

Direct Quotes

Max: "We use enterprise API subscriptions... in a way that is not going to be trained on your data."

Max: "When we get the enterprise access... they will not train on the data or include it in their models."

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Onboarding **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can Cranston work with desktop tax software?

Integrations | Product

Short Answer

Yes, for supported desktop tax systems Cranston uses a **desktop bridge/app** that connects the Cranston cloud workflow to the firm's local or hosted tax-software environment.

More Detail

The exact setup depends on the tax software and hosting environment. A Desktop Software call should verify version, hosting, permissions, installation, client mapping, and an actual import/export test before making broad promises.

Proof / Resources

Sources: Drake Setup + Pilot with Scott Sugg; Peter Burgos Drake review; Christopher Lee demo.

Direct Quotes

Max: "We install it on the desktop, and then that's what allows it to interface."

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Desktop Software **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Is pricing per seat or per return?

Pricing

Short Answer

Per return, not per seat. The goal is for the firm to put the right people in the product without seat pricing discouraging adoption.

More Detail

Use this when a prospect is thinking about how many preparers/reviewers need access. Keep the explanation tied to aligned incentives and adoption rather than overexplaining pricing mechanics.

Proof / Resources

Source: Steven Nuckols sales call this week.

Direct Quotes

Max: "We don't want to charge per seat because what we want to do is we want to give you as many seats as possible."

Use in: Discovery **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Does the $40 price include state returns and different return types?

Pricing | Product

Short Answer

The standard call language this week has been **$40 per return across the supported major federal return types, with state return work included rather than separately priced**.

More Detail

Max has described the same per-return price across 1040, 1065, 1120, and 1120S. For unusual state/local forms or unsupported edge cases, avoid promising coverage until confirmed.

Proof / Resources

Sources: Erica Whatley call; Robert Johnson call; multiple demos this week.

Direct Quotes

Max: "We charge $40 per return, and that's across all four forms."

Max: "It'll do the state return as well... and that's included under the $40 price."

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

Can we try Cranston before committing to a full rollout?

Implementation | Objections

Short Answer

Yes. The normal motion is to **test Cranston on a few representative returns first**, review the output together, and then decide on an appropriate pilot or broader rollout.

More Detail

The best test uses real returns the firm understands well enough to compare expected versus actual output. Depending on the prospect, the next step may be a small pilot for the remainder of the year before a larger tax-season commitment.

Proof / Resources

This pattern appeared repeatedly this week, including Steven Nuckols, Robert Johnson, Jennifer Reardon, Laura McClure, and Christopher Lee.

Direct Quotes

Max: "We'll let you try the product and... do a few sample returns to see if it works well for you."

Max: "We could do a smaller deal for... fifty returns... for the rest of this year."

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

How does Cranston get information into the tax return?

Workflow | Product | Integrations

Short Answer

Cranston takes the source documents and other supplied client information, extracts and reasons over the relevant data, shows the firm what it intends to use, and then pushes supported data into the connected tax software workflow.

More Detail

The important sales point is that this is not just OCR. The system reasons across multiple documents, surfaces findings/questions for human review, and provides a pre-import view so the accountant can inspect or correct information before it is pushed forward.

Proof / Resources

Sources: Laura McClure demo, Peter Burgos review, Christopher Lee demo, Ross/Max practice demos.

Direct Quotes

Max: "Whatever's in the documents, it'll pull."

Max: "Pre-import, here's what you're gonna see; you can fix it, you can push it."

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Desktop Software **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

How is Cranston priced?

Pricing

Short Answer

Cranston's standard starting price is **$40 per tax return**, rather than per seat. Pricing can vary with volume or a specifically approved pilot/offer.

More Detail

The per-return model is intended to keep cost predictable and let firms give access to the people who need it without paying for additional seats. Do not promise custom pricing unless it has been approved for that deal.

Proof / Resources

- Repeated in sales calls this week with Laura McClure, Erica Whatley, Steven Nuckols, Robert Johnson, and others.
- Current call language has referenced a minimum commitment for a full-season rollout; exact commercial terms should come from the current approved pricing policy.

Direct Quotes

Max: "We charge $40 per return."

Max: "We want you to have a fixed price where you know how much it's gonna cost."

Use in: Discovery, Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page

What happens when Cranston is missing information or a document?

Accuracy | Workflow

Short Answer

Cranston should **surface the missing or uncertain item for review rather than silently guessing**. The user can then resolve it with an additional document, an instruction, or a client request.

More Detail

Use examples such as a missing consolidated 1099, mortgage statement, or client information that was never uploaded. During an output review, distinguish a real product error from a difference caused by missing inputs.

Proof / Resources

This came up repeatedly in trial/output-review calls this week. Joey Greco's review, for example, found differences caused by inputs that had not been uploaded rather than Cranston logic errors.

Direct Quotes

Max: "The more... documents that have all this information, the AI will pull in all the information from all the documents."

Use in: Hands-on Demo, Output Review **Last reviewed:** 2026-08-14 Open source page